

John Okari

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Personal Statement

Seasoned Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience building scalable, high-performance applications using Ruby on Rails, Python (FastAPI), Elixir (Phoenix), and modern JavaScript frameworks. Skilled in RESTful API design, cloud deployments, and Agile practices, with a track record of improving system performance and leading cross-functional teams in mission-driven projects.

Technical Skills

- **Backend:** Ruby on Rails, Elixir (Phoenix), Python (FastAPI), PHP (Laravel)
 - **Frontend:** React.js, Vue.js, Next.js, Phoenix LiveView
 - **Testing:** RSpec, ExUnit, TDD/BDD
 - **DevOps:** Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Linux, Redis
 - **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB
 - **Cloud:** AWS, Azure (basic GCP) | Tools: Git, Jira, Agile/Scrum
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Professional Experience

Software Engineer | JijiHealth, Nairobi

August 2024 – Present

- Led the development of scalable Health Management Information Systems (HMIS) using Ruby on Rails and PostgreSQL, ensuring high availability and performance.
- Designed and maintained RESTful APIs for seamless integration with external healthcare systems, improving data accessibility by 30%.
- Implemented secure payment processing endpoints (Mpesa, Quikk) with robust callback handling, enhancing transaction reliability.
- Conducted code reviews and wrote RSpec tests to ensure code quality and maintainability.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams in Agile sprints to deliver optimised, user-focused solutions.

Key Achievement: Enhanced HMIS platform scalability, enabling real-time data sharing across healthcare facilities, reducing latency by 25%.

Software Developer | Damu Sasa, Nairobi

January 2023 – December 2024

- Developed and maintained RESTful APIs using Ruby on Rails, ensuring seamless integration with frontend applications and third-party systems.
- Optimised cloud-based deployments (GCP, Digital Ocean) for the Blood Management Information System (BMIS), improving system uptime to 99.9%.

- Participated in Agile sprints, analysing user stories and contributing to scalable system designs.
Key Achievement: Led BMIS revamp, integrating with The Nairobi Hospital's labware, enabling secure and efficient data exchange.

Software Developer | SoftTec Innovation Africa, Nairobi

January 2021 – December 2022

- Built REST APIs with FastAPI & integrated 3rd-party services to streamline workflows.
- Improved system issue resolution by **50%** through proactive troubleshooting.
Key Achievement: Designed scalable backend systems to support growing user bases, improving performance under high load.

Highlighted Projects

- **E-Learning Platform (2024):** Scalable platform using Rails, Vue.js & PostgreSQL; improved performance by **20%** via optimised queries.
- **Blood Management System (2023):** Rails + Vue.js solution enabling real-time hospital labware integration; deployed with Docker for high availability.
- **CodeOverflow (2023):** Stack Overflow clone built with Rails & React.
- **Proctor (2020):** Doctor-patient platform using Laravel & JS.

Education

Moringa School, Nairobi

November 2021 – May 2022

Software Engineering – Full-Stack Developer

The Technical University of Kenya, Nairobi

September 2016 – March 2021

Bachelor of Technology in Information Technology

Personal Skills

- Fast learner • Strong communicator • Critical thinker • Skilled in scalable backend architecture